

| Assessment | Test | Domain  | Skill            | Difficulty                                        |
|------------|------|---------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| SAT        | Math | Algebra | Linear functions | Easy <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |

Question

The graph of the function  $f$  is a line in the  $xy$ -plane. If the line has slope  $\frac{3}{4}$  and  $f(0) = 3$ , which of the following defines  $f$ ?

Answer

- A.  $f(x) = \frac{3}{4}x - 3$
- B.  $f(x) = \frac{3}{4}x + 3$
- C.  $f(x) = 4x - 3$
- D.  $f(x) = 4x + 3$

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. The equation for the function  $f$  in the  $xy$ -plane can be represented by  $f(x) = mx + b$ , where  $m$  is the slope and  $b$  is the  $y$ -coordinate of the  $y$ -intercept. Since it's given that the line has a slope of  $\frac{3}{4}$ , it follows that  $m = \frac{3}{4}$  in  $f(x) = mx + b$ , which yields  $y = \frac{3}{4}x + b$ . It's given that  $f(0) = 3$ . This implies that the graph of the function  $f$  in the  $xy$ -plane passes through the point  $(0, 3)$ . Thus, the  $y$ -coordinate of the  $y$ -intercept of the graph is 3, so  $b = 3$  in  $f(x) = \frac{3}{4}x + b$ , which yields  $f(x) = \frac{3}{4}x + 3$ . Therefore, the equation  $f(x) = \frac{3}{4}x + 3$  defines the function  $f$ .

Choice A is incorrect and may result from a sign error for the  $y$ -intercept. Choice C is incorrect and may result from using the denominator of the given slope as  $m$  in  $f(x) = mx + b$ , in addition to a sign error for the  $y$ -intercept. Choice D is incorrect and may result from using the denominator of the given slope as  $m$  in  $f(x) = mx + b$ .